

Set Operations

CS1010 Discrete Mathematics for Computer Science

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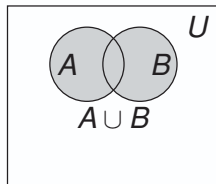
Union

Definition

The **union** of sets A and B , denoted by $A \cup B$, is the set containing elements that are in A , or in B , or in both.

$$A \cup B = \{x \mid x \in A \vee x \in B\}$$

- $\mathcal{Q}$. What is $\{1, 3, 9\} \cup \{3, 6, 9\}$?
- $\mathcal{A}$. $\{1, 3, 6, 9\}$ (Notice that 3 and 9 are not written twice.)



Intersection

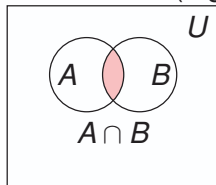
Definition

The **intersection** of sets A and B , denoted by $A \cap B$, is the set containing elements that are in both A and B .

$$A \cap B = \{x \mid x \in A \wedge x \in B\}$$

Disjoint Sets: If two sets have no elements in common (e.g., $A \cap B = \emptyset$)

- ▶ $\{2, 4, 6, 8, 10\} \cap \{1, 2, 3, 5, 7\} = \{2\}$
- ▶ $\{2, 4, 6, 8\} \cap \{1, 3, 5, 7, 9\} = \emptyset$



Theorem: For any finite sets A and B : $|A \cup B| = |A| + |B| - |A \cap B|$

Generalized Unions and Intersections

Definitions

Let $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ be an indexed collection of sets:

$$\bigcup_{i=1}^n A_i = A_1 \cup A_2 \cup \dots \cup A_n \text{ and } \bigcap_{i=1}^n A_i = A_1 \cap A_2 \cap \dots \cap A_n$$

Q. For $i = 1, 2, 3, \dots$ and let $A_i = [-i, i]$. Find $\bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i$ and $\bigcap_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i$.

A. **Generalized Union:** As i grows, the intervals expand outward:
 $[-1, 1] \subset [-2, 2] \subset [-3, 3] \subset \dots$ Eventually, the union covers all real numbers:

$$\bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i = (-\infty, \infty) = \mathbb{R}$$

A. **Generalized Intersection:** $\bigcap_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i = A_1 = [-1, 1]$



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Quick Check: Union and Intersection

Union asks: "Does it belong to at least one?"

Intersection asks: "Does it belong to all?"

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A. $|A \cup B| = |A| + |B| - |A \cap B| = 20 + 15 - 6 = 29$.

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Q. If $A \cap B = A$, what can you conclude about A and B ?

A. $A \subseteq B$. Every element of A belongs to $A \cap B$, and therefore belongs to B .



Complement

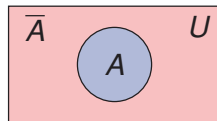
Definition

The **complement** of set A (with respect to U), denoted by $\bar{A}$ (or A^c), is the set of elements in U that are not in A .

$$\bar{A} = \{x \in U \mid x \notin A\} = U - A$$

Q. Let $U = \{0, 1, 2, \dots, 9\}$. What is the complement of the set of even digits $E = \{x \in U \mid x \text{ is even}\}$?

A. $\bar{E} = \{1, 3, 5, 7, 9\}$ (the set of odd digits in U).



Difference

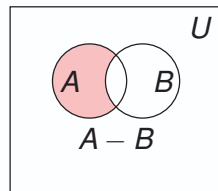
Definition

The **difference** of sets A and B , denoted by $A - B$, is the set containing elements of A that are not in B .

$$A - B = \{x \mid x \in A \wedge x \notin B\} = A \cap \overline{B}$$

Example:

- ▶ $A = \{\text{Red, Blue, Yellow}\}$, $B = \{\text{Red, Blue, Green}\}$
- ▶ $A - B = \{\text{Yellow}\}$ and $B - A = \{\text{Green}\}$
- ▶ In general, $A - B \neq B - A$



Summary of Basic Set Operations

Set operations provide a direct connection between **set theory and logic**.

Operation	Membership condition	Logical idea
$A \cup B$	$x \in A \vee x \in B$	OR
$A \cap B$	$x \in A \wedge x \in B$	AND
$\bar{A}$	$x \notin A$	NOT
$A - B$	$x \in A \wedge x \notin B$	AND + NOT

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Q. Let $U = \{1, 2, \dots, 10\}$, $A = \{2, 4, 6, 8, 10\}$, $B = \{2, 3, 5, 7\}$. Find $\overline{A}$ and $A - B$.

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A. $\bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i = \mathbb{Z}^+$ and $\bigcap_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i = \emptyset$

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Q. Suppose $A \cup B = A \cap B$. What can you conclude about A and B ?

A. $A = B$. Indeed, if an element belongs to A , then it belongs to $A \cup B$, and hence to $A \cap B$, so it must also belong to B . Similarly, $B \subseteq A$.

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Q. Can two non-empty sets satisfy $A \cap B = \emptyset$ and $A \cup B = \emptyset$?

A. No. If $A \cup B = \emptyset$, then both A and B must be empty. Thus, $A = B = \emptyset$.

Set Identities: Core Laws (1)

Identity	Name
$A \cup \emptyset = A$ $A \cap U = A$	Identity Laws
$A \cup U = U$ $A \cap \emptyset = \emptyset$	Domination Laws
$A \cup A = A$ $A \cap A = A$	Idempotent Laws
$\overline{(\overline{A})} = A$	Complementation Law

Set Identities: Core Laws (2)

Identity	Name
$A \cup B = B \cup A$ $A \cap B = B \cap A$	Commutative Laws
$A \cup (B \cap C) = (A \cup B) \cap (A \cup C)$ $A \cap (B \cup C) = (A \cap B) \cup (A \cap C)$	Distributive Laws

Set Identities: De Morgan's & Remaining Laws

Identity	Name
$\overline{A \cup B} = \overline{A} \cap \overline{B}$ $\overline{A \cap B} = \overline{A} \cup \overline{B}$	De Morgan's Laws
$A \cup (A \cap B) = A$ $A \cap (A \cup B) = A$	Absorption Laws
$A \cup \overline{A} = U$ $A \cap \overline{A} = \emptyset$	Complement Laws

Proof of De Morgan's Law

De Morgan's Law: $\overline{A \cup B} = \bar{A} \cap \bar{B}$

$$\overline{A \cup B} = \{x \mid x \notin A \cup B\}$$

by definition of complement

$$= \{x \mid \neg(x \in A \cup B)\}$$

by definition of $\notin$

$$= \{x \mid \neg(x \in A \vee x \in B)\}$$

by definition of union

$$= \{x \mid \neg(x \in A) \wedge \neg(x \in B)\}$$

by De Morgan's law for logic

$$= \{x \mid x \notin A \wedge x \notin B\}$$

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$$= \{x \mid x \in \bar{A} \wedge x \in \bar{B}\}$$

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Proof of the Absorption Law

Absorption Law: $A \cup (A \cap B) = A$

$$A \cup (A \cap B) = \{x \mid x \in A \cup (A \cap B)\}$$

by meaning of set-builder notation

$$= \{x \mid x \in A \vee x \in (A \cap B)\}$$

by definition of union

$$= \{x \mid x \in A \vee (x \in A \wedge x \in B)\}$$

by definition of intersection

$$= \{x \mid x \in A\}$$

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Set Identity: Difference of Sets

Problem

Let A , B , and C be sets. Show that $(A - B) - C = (A - C) - (B - C)$.

Proof: We prove equality by showing that an arbitrary element x belongs to the left-hand side if and only if it belongs to the right-hand side.

$$\begin{aligned}x \in (A - B) - C &\iff x \in (A - B) \wedge x \notin C \\&\iff (x \in A \wedge x \notin B) \wedge x \notin C \\&\iff x \in A \wedge x \notin C \wedge x \notin B \\&\iff x \in (A - C) \wedge x \notin (B - C) \\&\iff x \in (A - C) - (B - C).\end{aligned}$$

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Set Identity: Subsets and Complements

Problem

Let A and B be subsets of a universal set U . Show that $A \subseteq B \iff \bar{B} \subseteq \bar{A}$.

($\Rightarrow$) Suppose $A \subseteq B$. We want to show that $\bar{B} \subseteq \bar{A}$.

Let $x \in \bar{B}$. Then $x \notin B$. Since $A \subseteq B$, $x \notin A$, and hence $x \in \bar{A}$. Thus, $\bar{B} \subseteq \bar{A}$.

($\Leftarrow$) Suppose $\bar{B} \subseteq \bar{A}$. Let $x \in A$. We want to show that $x \in B$.

Suppose, for contradiction, that $x \notin B$. Then $x \in \bar{B}$. Since $\bar{B} \subseteq \bar{A}$, we obtain $x \in \bar{A}$, which means $x \notin A$ — a contradiction. Therefore, $x \in B$, and hence $A \subseteq B$.

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Set Identity: Cartesian Product and Difference

Problem

Let A , B , and C be sets. Show that $A \times (B - C) = (A \times B) - (A \times C)$.

($\subseteq$) Let $(x, y) \in A \times (B - C)$. Then $x \in A$ and $y \in B - C$. Hence $y \in B$ and $y \notin C$. Therefore, $(x, y) \in A \times B$ but $(x, y) \notin A \times C$. Thus $(x, y) \in (A \times B) - (A \times C)$. Hence, $A \times (B - C) \subseteq (A \times B) - (A \times C)$.

($\supseteq$) Let $(x, y) \in (A \times B) - (A \times C)$. Then $(x, y) \in A \times B$ and $(x, y) \notin A \times C$. Thus $x \in A$ and $y \in B$.

Since $x \in A$ and $(x, y) \notin A \times C$, we must have $y \notin C$. Hence $y \in B - C$, and therefore $(x, y) \in A \times (B - C)$.

Thus, $(A \times B) - (A \times C) \subseteq A \times (B - C)$.

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Set Identities: Practice

Q. Show that

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Q. Show that

$$(A \cap B) \cup (A \cap \overline{B}) = A.$$

A. Using the distributive law,

$$\begin{aligned}(A \cap B) \cup (A \cap \overline{B}) &= A \cap (B \cup \overline{B}) \\ &= A \cap U \\ &= A.\end{aligned}$$

Quick Check: Set Operations

What can you say about the sets A and B if we know that

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Q. What can you say if $A - B = B - A$?

A. $A = B$.



Thank You for your
attention!

Any questions?